

FDE FIELD NOTES · ISSUE 04 OF 10

Do not invent the ROI.

Measure the baseline before you build anything.

04

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Baseline before build

01 Time per item

Measured on real work, not estimated in a meeting.

02 Error or rework rate

How often a human has to redo it.

03 Queue length

What is waiting at the start of each shift.

04 Cost of a miss

What a wrong or late item actually costs.

Invented vs measured

INVENTED

- Vendor benchmark
- Best-case demo data
- Percent saved, no baseline
- Nobody can recompute it

MEASURED

- Two weeks of real items
- Same items, before and after
- Minutes saved per shift
- Formula lives in the repo

Metrics that hold up

METRIC	TYPE	WHY
Agreement with operator	Leading	Trust before scale
Queue time at 9am	Leading	Operator feels it
Rework rate	Lagging	Quality signal
Cost per item	Lagging	The finance view

Make it recomputable

01 Log the inputs

Every number traces back to raw events.

02 Formula in code

Versioned, reviewed, not in a spreadsheet tab.

03 Next shift can rerun it

If only you can produce it, it is not a metric.



THE TEST

Could a skeptic recompute it?

If not, call it a hypothesis and say what you will measure next.



KEY TAKEAWAY

An honest small number beats an impressive invented one.

- Measure the baseline first
- Use the operator's units: minutes, queue, rework
- Keep the formula in the repo

YOUR TURN

What is the most invented ROI number you have seen in a deck?

FOLLOW AKHILESH RANJAN SINGH

Next in the series: #05 When the operator overturns the score

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